1. Title: A Comparative Analysis of Gender based Management Styles of Software Project Managers
Authors, year, where published: Ahmed Ali Qureshi, Saima Afzal, Imran Daud and Muhammad Asad Saleem, 2013, International Journal of Computer Applications (0975 – 8887) Volume 71– No.14
Type of Study: Survey: 27- item questionnaire and interviews
Who they studied: Employees who had worked under both a male and female SPMs (Software Project Managers). 100 Responses (40 males, 60 females) from software houses in Islamabad and Rawalpindi cities of Pakistan
Main finding: Both male and female employees rated male SPMs higher in terms of leadership qualities, decision making, communication, initiative and problem solving. Female SPMs were rated as more biased, less approachable and more autocratic. The authors concluded that skills and training are more important factors than gender.
Engineer vs Manager: This paper only shows what engineers think of manager's styles.
Useful for us because: It shows that engineers notice and judge manager behaviour such as approachability and fairness, which we can test in interviews.
Quote or number worth citing: 82.5% of male and 50% of female employees chose male SPMs as more effective for running a project smoothly (p. 15).

2. Title: Software Developers' Perceptions of Soft Skills in Software Requirements Engineering
Authors, year, where published: Tamara Zoric, Zeljko Stojanov, 2018, Journal of Engineering Management and Competitiveness (JEMC), Vol. 8 No. 1, pp. 54–64
Type of Study: Semi-structured interviews
Who they studied: 14 Software Developers (5 working in indigenous software companies, 6 working for foreign software companies, and 3 working as freelancers) in the Banat region of Serbia.
Main finding: The majority of software developers are aware that soft skills are necessary, but they don't think about them day to day and just use them without noticing. Most of them see soft skills as communication with clients and fitting into the company. They said specialized courses and workshops could help them improve.
Engineer vs manager: Only Engineers were interviewed. The authors suggest managers could use the findings to plan soft skills training sessions.
Useful for us because: It gives the engineers' own view that soft skills are important but taken for granted, which we can compare with what managers say.
Quote or number worth citing: A short quote from Participant 1: soft skills are sometimes hard to recognise because technical skills are so important (p. 60).

3. Title: How (Un)happiness Impacts on Software Engineers in Agile Teams?
Authors, year, where published: Luís Felipe Amorim, Marcelo Marinho and Suzana Sampaio, 2020, International Journal of Software Engineering & Applications (IJSEA), Vol.11, No.3
Type of study: Case study (survey and interviews)
Who they studied: 67 people (Testers, Developers, Project Managers, Technical Leads, Project Leader and UI/UX Designers) working in five different agile project teams in an Innovation Culture Company at Recife, Brazil.

Main finding: Happiness factors for Software Engineers are effective communication, motivated team members, collaboration, proactive members, and present leaders.
Engineer vs manager: Mostly the engineer view, but it shows managers and leaders affect engineer wellbeing through being present and recognising work.
Useful for us because: It ties manager and leader behaviour directly to how engineers feel and perform.
Quote or number worth citing: The five happiness factors are listed in the conclusion (p. 55).(effective communication, motivated members, collaboration among members, proactive members, present leaders)

4. Title: What Makes a Great Software Quality Assurance Engineer?
Authors, year, where published: Roselane Silva Farias, Iftekhar Ahmed and Eduardo Santana de Almeida, 2025, IEEE Transactions on Software Engineering, Vol. 51, No. 4
Type of study: Interviews and Survey
Who they studied: 25 Software Quality Assurance(SQA) engineers interviewed from different companies from five countries: USA (13), Brazil (9), India (1), Portugal (1), and Canada (1). And 363 SQA professionals surveyed from 18 different nationalities.
Main finding: They found 25 attributes in five groups (personal, social, technical, management and decision-making). The authors concluded that curiosity, effective communication, and critical thinking best separate great SQA engineers.
Engineer vs manager: The paper compares SQA attributes with studies of software engineers and managers. 21 of the 25 SQA attributes also appeared in the software engineer studies, so the roles are very similar. Some attributes are role-specific, for example autonomy for managers.
Useful for us because: This paper directly compares engineer and manager attributes so it's the strongest source for similarities and differences between roles.
Quote or number worth citing: Curiosity was mentioned by 20 of 25 interviewees (p. 5). 84% of great-SQA attributes are shared with software engineers (p. 16). Autonomy was only mentioned for managers (p. 12).

5. Title: AI Agentic Scriptless Automation in Software Testing
Authors, year, where published: Ganesh Viswanathan, 2024, International Journal of Computer Trends and Technology, Vol. 72 Issue 9, pp. 120–125
Type of study: Review
Who they studied: Nobody. It's a technical overview of scriptless test tools and AI agents.
Main finding: Scriptless testing (visual, keyword-based) reduces the scripting skills needed and the maintenance work. The paper argues the next step is AI agents that create, run, and repair tests with little human involvement. It also lists limits: limited customisation, performance overhead, vendor lock-in, and a learning curve for technical users.
Engineer vs manager: It says almost nothing about either role. The closest point is that non-technical people could take part in testing.
Useful for us because: It gives background on how AI may change testers' work, but it has no evidence about engineers or managers.
Quote or number worth citing: Nothing

6. Title: The Alignment Between Business Objectives Clarity and Software Objectives
Authors, year, where published: Mohammad Mahmoud Tarawneh, 2019, Computer Engineering and Intelligent Systems (IISTE), Vol. 10 No. 2, pp. 28–32
Type of study: Survey and Interviews
Who they studied: 100 software project managers surveyed and 15 of them were interviewed in Jordan.
Main finding: The author concludes that clear business objectives aligned with software objectives support project success. Managers reported high levels of problems such as weak priorities and unclear task order. Employees having the chance to ask what to do scored highest.
Engineer vs manager: Only the manager view. Managers are responsible for clarifying objectives with business owners, and engineers depend on that.
Useful for us because: It's one of the only manager-only sources, and it supports the idea that unclear goals start with management but affect engineers.
Quote or number worth citing: Overall mean of 3.61 ("high"), and "employees know the required objectives" ranked lowest at 62.9% (both p. 30). (Not relevant)

Conclusions

- **Engineers only:** Papers 2, 3, and 4 (and 1 gives engineers' views of managers). **Managers only:** Paper 6. No paper directly compares engineers and managers except Paper 4.
- **Weak sources:** Papers 1, 5, and 6 are low-tier. Paper 5 doesn't fit and is a candidate for "no" and a replacement. Papers 1 and 6 could be kept as weak evidence.
- **Key references to look up:** Li, Ko and Zhu (2015) and Kalliamvakou et al. (2019). Kalliamvakou et al. could be the best replacement or addition, since it studies engineers and managers together.

Interview ideas

- Paper 2 says engineers use soft skills without noticing them. Do managers see the same, or do they notice more?
- Paper 4 says 84% of attributes are shared between roles. Do professionals feel the roles are that similar?
- Papers 3 and 6 say unclear goals hurt teams. Who do engineers and managers each blame?
- Paper 1 says approachability matters. Do managers think they're approachable, and do engineers agree?